

zomato GOLD

PRODUCT CASE STUDY — MEMBERSHIP RETENTION

From discount pass to daily habit.

A retention strategy to cut Zomato Gold's 45% three-month churn — grounded in primary research, prioritized with RICE, designed around the ecosystem Zomato already owns.

TEAM VISIONARY VANGUARDS

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ARYAN MAAN

MEMBER · RENEWS MONTHLY?

The card 45% of members walk away from.

Zomato in 2026 — an ecosystem, not an app

Eternal's four verticals give Zomato the widest consumer surface in Indian food-tech.

₹23,450 Cr

Total revenue, FY26E

Motilal Oswal / CLSA est.

32.5 M

Monthly transacting users

across the platform

60%

Food-delivery market share

vs. Swiggy at ~40%

₹2,850 Cr

Net profit, FY25

profitable at scale



Food Delivery

₹9,200 Cr revenue

The core engine — where Gold lives today.



Hyperpure

₹8,500 Cr revenue

B2B supply backbone for 3L+ restaurant partners.



Blinkit

₹35,000 Cr+ GOV

Quick commerce, 2,000+ dark stores. A weekly habit.



District

Dining · events · tickets

Going-out super-app driving ecosystem lock-in.

The setup: Zomato owns groceries, dining and events — yet Gold monetizes only food delivery. That gap is the story of this deck.

Gold wins the sign-up — then loses the renewal

Perceived value collapses in month 2, long before the renewal decision.

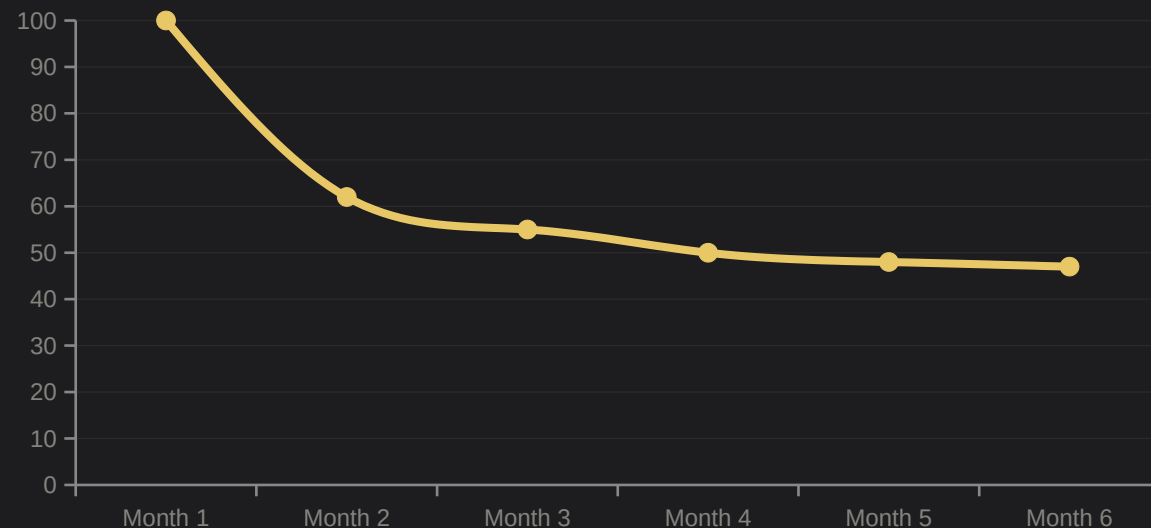
₹1-₹399 DYNAMIC ENTRY

FREE DELIVERY OVER ₹99

DINING DISCOUNTS

PRIORITY PERKS

PERCEIVED VALUE OF GOLD BY MEMBERSHIP MONTH (SURVEY INDEX)



45%

of Gold members do not renew after month 3

Cancellation reason #1: "Didn't order enough to justify it."

65%

use delivery perks only

M2

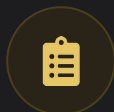
sharpest value drop

HOW MIGHT WE turn Gold from a transactional discount into an everyday membership members refuse to cancel?

How we investigated

Mixed-method research across the full membership lifecycle — sign-up to churn.

01



Primary survey

71 Gold users — active, churned and expired — across Delhi NCR.

PRICING, USAGE, RENEWAL INTENT

02



Personas

Clustered respondents into 4 archetypes by frequency, spend and motivation.

2 POWER USERS · 2 AT-RISK

03

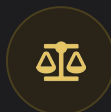


Journey mapping

Traced 11 touchpoints from discovery to renewal; scored drop-off risk at each.

CHECKOUT = CRITICAL LEAK

04



Benchmarking

Compared Gold vs. Swiggy One, EatSure Elite, ONDC and QSR loyalty programs.

ECOSYSTEM GAP
EXPOSED

Rigor note: every problem taken forward is validated by at least two methods — survey signal + journey or benchmark evidence.

What 71 members told us

Six signals that explain the churn — and point at what to build.

74%

of orders are under ₹500

Solo meals dominate — thresholds punish the core use case.

71%

order weekly or more

High-frequency users: huge LTV, easily lost.

52%

run Swiggy side-by-side

Zero lock-in. Every order is re-shopped.

45%

cancel after 3 months

“Didn’t order enough to justify it.”

M2

is the peak value drop

Novelty fades before habit forms.

65%

touch delivery perks only

Blinkit & District benefits go unseen.

Core insight: Gold is being used as a coupon, not a membership. Members re-shop every order because nothing makes staying obviously better.

The power users Gold strains

High-frequency members who want to stay — and are being made to work for it.



Rohan Sharma

THE BUDGET STUDENT · 4–6 ORDERS/WK · AOV ₹150–300

"I order almost every day, but the ₹99 minimum makes me spend more than I actually need."

Active Gold

STATUS

Power user

PERSONA TYPE

Max savings

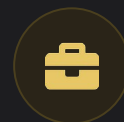
DECISION DRIVER

⚠️ PAIN POINTS

- ₹99 min cart forces over-ordering
- Platform + surge fees erode savings
- No student-focused plan

✅ NEEDS

- Threshold-free solo orders
- Transparent final pricing
- Rewards for frequent small orders



Anjali Verma

THE BUSY PROFESSIONAL · 5–7 ORDERS/WK · AOV ₹500–800

"I pay for Gold to save time — hidden charges and delayed deliveries reduce its value."

Active Gold

STATUS

Power user

PERSONA TYPE

Time & reliability

DECISION DRIVER

⚠️ PAIN POINTS

- Peak-hour delays wreck lunch breaks
- Hidden platform & surge fees
- Support is a chatbot loop

✅ NEEDS

- A delivery-time promise
- Priority human support
- Consistent premium treatment

The members already halfway out

One churned to Swiggy One; one is active but sees none of Gold's wider value.



Rahul Singh

THE PRICE CHECKER · CHURNED TO SWIGGY ONE ·
AOV ₹300–500

"I don't care which app I use — I simply order from the one offering the lowest final price."

Churned

STATUS

At-risk

PERSONA TYPE

Lowest final price

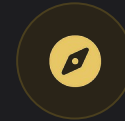
DECISION DRIVER

⚠️ PAIN POINTS

- Swiggy's final price is often lower
- Hidden charges reduce trust
- Generic discounts, zero loyalty

✅ NEEDS

- Price-match confidence
- Transparent checkout
- A reason not to re-shop each order



Sneha Kapoor

THE DINING EXPLORER · ORDERS DAILY · AOV ₹150–300

"I don't just want food discounts — I want dining experiences and exclusive perks."

Active Gold

STATUS

At-risk

PERSONA TYPE

Experiences

DECISION DRIVER

⚠️ PAIN POINTS

- Gold feels delivery-only
- District & dining perks invisible
- Rewards feel generic

✅ NEEDS

- Experience-led benefits
- Event & dining suggestions
- Perks beyond the food order

Where the journey leaks

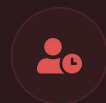
Eleven touchpoints mapped; the money walks out at price-check, cart — and quietly after the order.

							
Home	Search	Menu	Add items	Gold check	Price check	Cart	Post-order
<i>"Is Gold worth it?"</i>	<i>"Which restaurant?"</i>	<i>"What should I order?"</i>	<i>"Should I add more?"</i>	<i>"Will Gold apply?"</i>	<i>"Why is the bill rising?"</i>	<i>"Why is Gold locked?"</i>	<i>"Was Gold worth it?"</i>
LOW	LOW	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	HIGH	VERY HIGH	CRITICAL	HIGH



The checkout cliff

Hidden platform & surge fees surface at price-check; the ₹99 barrier locks Gold at cart. Highest-intent moment, highest drop-off — users abandon or switch apps to compare.



The silent post-order churn

After delivery, Gold disappears: no reminder of savings, no progress, no reason to renew. By month 2 the membership is invisible — and month 3 is the cancellation.

Read: fixing checkout friction alone treats the symptom. Retention needs Gold to matter between orders, not just at them.

Eight problems surfaced. Four earn a bet.

Filtered on severity × frequency in the survey × strategic fit with Zomato's ecosystem.



BET →

Ecosystem gap

Swiggy One bundles food + Instamart; Gold covers food only.



BET →

No Gold support lane

Chatbot-only support; rivals ship priority queues.



BET →

Lunch-hour misses

40–50 min standard delivery breaks the office lunch window.



BET →

Choice overload

Endless options; 15 minutes of scrolling to pick one meal.



Hidden fees

Platform + surge charges appear late and erode trust.



₹99 cart barrier

Solo orders forced to over-buy to unlock benefits.



Invisible perks

65% never touch Blinkit / District / dining benefits.



No student plan

Price-led students churn to cheaper rivals.

Why these four: fees, thresholds and visibility are worth fixing — but they're table stakes. The four bets change what Gold is, not just what it costs.

Four bets to make Gold unquittable

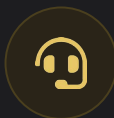
Each bet pairs a validated problem with a solution only Zomato can ship at this scale.

**BET 1**

Swiggy One out-values Gold with its food + grocery bundle.

**GOLD EVERYWHERE**

One membership across Zomato, Blinkit & District — free grocery delivery, event perks, one gold badge everywhere.

**BET 2**

Gold members get the same chatbot as everyone else.

**GOLD PRIORITY SUPPORT**

A human-first support lane with a 60-second pickup promise and auto-credit for order failures.

**BET 3**

A 40–50 min delivery doesn't fit a 60-minute lunch break.

**GOLD EXPRESS**

A 30–35 minute promise on Express-eligible lunch orders — priority dispatch, no batching.

**BET 4**

Too many options: members burn their break deciding.

**GOLD AI CONCIERGE**

A personal meal agent that knows your usuals, budget and break — one tap from craving to cart.

RICE says: bundle first

Score = (Reach × Impact × Confidence) ÷ Effort. Ecosystem bundling wins on reach and build cost.

BET	REACH /10	IMPACT /3	CONF.	EFFORT (PM)	RICE SCORE	
Gold Everywhere	9	3.0	90%	3	8.1	SHIP FIRST
Priority Support	4	2.0	90%	2	3.6	
Gold Express	6	2.5	70%	6	1.75	
AI Concierge	5	2.0	60%	7	0.86	

Why the winner wins: Blinkit and District are already Zomato-owned. Swiggy must operate Instamart to fund its bundle; Zomato only has to flip a membership flag. Integration, not construction.

Scales — Reach: share of Gold base touched per quarter. Impact: 0.25–3 (Intercom scale). Confidence: evidence strength. Effort: person-months.

Gold Everywhere — one membership, three apps

Counter Swiggy One's bundle with the ecosystem Zomato already owns.

WHY THIS

52% of members re-shop every order and Swiggy One's grocery bundle is the #1 stated reason to switch. Zomato's unfair advantage: Blinkit and District are in-house. Extending Gold across them creates daily utility no rival can match without buying one.

HOW IT WORKS



Free Blinkit delivery — on member orders over ₹199 — turns a weekly grocery run into a Gold habit.



District member pricing — waived convenience fees + early access on events and dining.



One Gold identity — single badge, wallet and savings tracker across all three apps.

SUCCESS METRICS

MULTI-APP USAGE 35% → 60%

D90 RENEWAL +8-10 PP

4 → 4.4 ORDERS / MO

zomato GOLD

ARYAN M.



GOLD · ALL ACCESS

Saved ₹1,240 this month



Zomato

Free delivery · priority perks



Blinkit

Free delivery over ₹199



District

Member pricing · early access

ONE MEMBERSHIP · THREE APPS

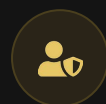
Gold Priority Support — a human in 60 seconds

Premium members shouldn't queue behind free users when an order goes wrong.

WHY THIS

Support failure is the sharpest trust-breaker for high-LTV professionals — and Swiggy One already ships a priority queue. When a ₹800 dinner is late, a chatbot loop converts a Gold advocate into a churned member in one incident.

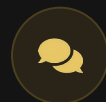
HOW IT WORKS



Dedicated Gold lane — human-first queue for active-order issues, 60-second pickup promise.



Auto-remediation — late or cold order? Credit lands before the member has to ask.



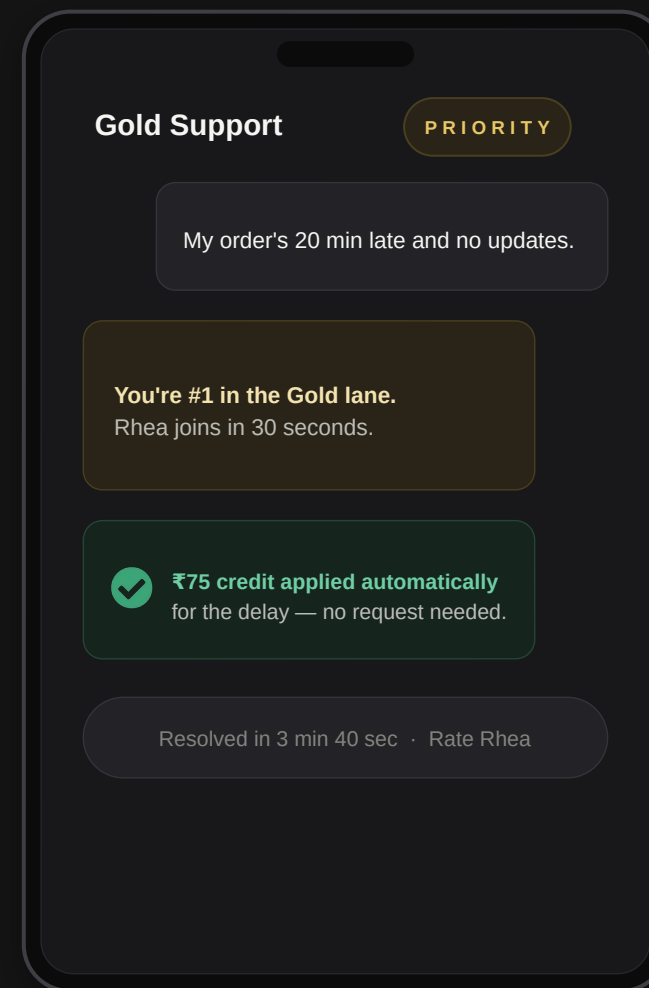
Visible priority — the chat shows the Gold lane working — queue position, agent ETA, resolution timer.

SUCCESS METRICS

SUPPORT CSAT +20 PP

BAD-ORDER CHURN -30%

RESPONSE < 60 SEC



Gold Express — lunch in 30–35 minutes, promised

Make the office lunch break a use case Zomato owns.

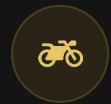
WHY THIS

Anjali gets 60 minutes for lunch. At 40–50 minutes of delivery, eating becomes a gamble — so professionals default to the canteen. A kept 30–35 minute promise converts the highest-frequency daypart in food delivery into Gold's signature moment.

HOW IT WORKS



Express-eligible selection — restaurants within 2.5 km with under-15-min prep get the Express badge at lunch.



Priority dispatch — nearest rider, no order batching, kitchen-ready timing for Gold Express orders.



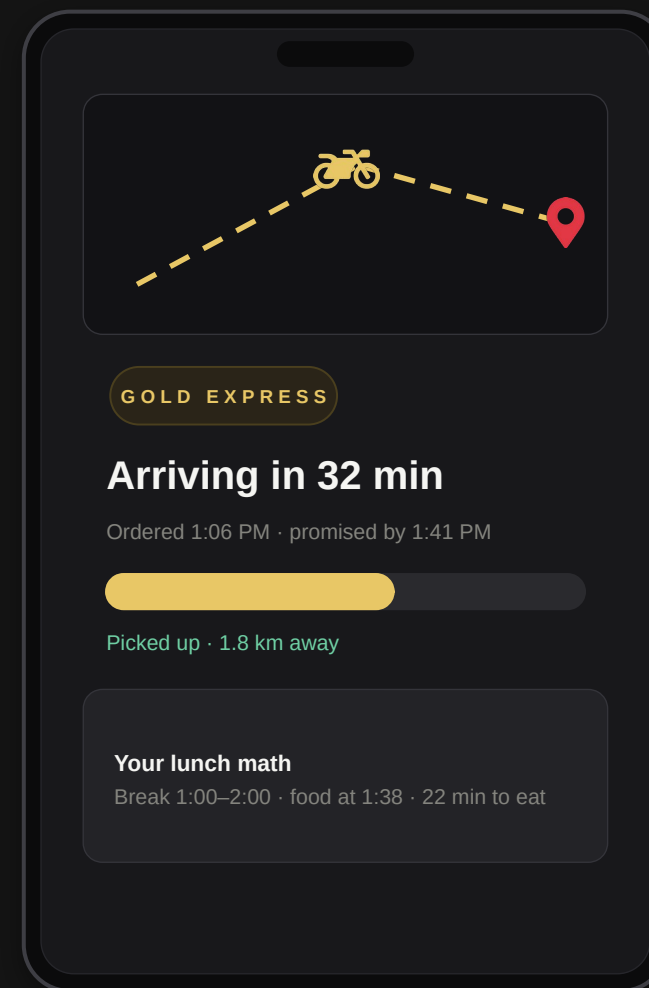
Promise with teeth — arrives past 35 minutes? ₹50 credit lands automatically. Trust is the feature.

SUCCESS METRICS

LUNCH ORDERS +15%

PRO-PERSONA CHURN -25%

ON-TIME > 95%



Gold AI Concierge — from craving to cart in one tap

Kill decision fatigue for members whose patterns Zomato already knows.

WHY THIS

It's 2 PM. Zomato knows this member lunches now, orders biryani twice a week, spends about ₹200, and needs delivery inside a 35-minute window. Today the app shows 400 restaurants anyway. The Concierge turns that history into one confident suggestion — and a fallback rail of three.

HOW IT WORKS



Learns the member — order history, time-of-day, budget envelope and delivery-time constraints.



One-tap decision — a single best pick with price and ETA that fit the moment; three alternates behind it.



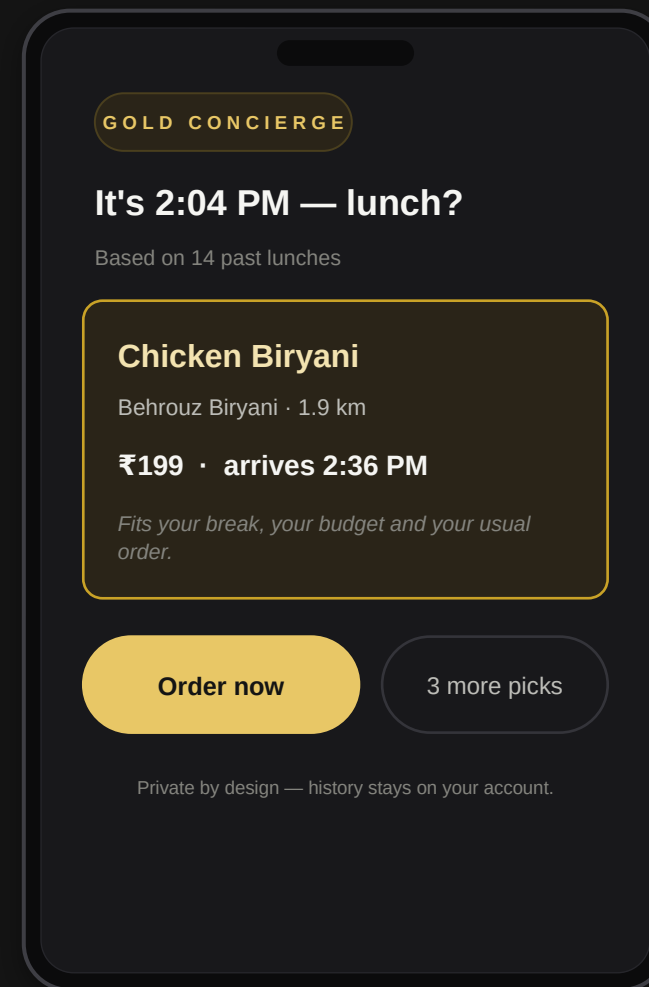
Validate cheap, then scale — Phase-3 per RICE — pilot as a rule-based “your usuals” rail before the ML build.

SUCCESS METRICS

TIME-TO-ORDER -40%

LUNCH CONV. +12%

ACCEPT RATE > 35%



What success looks like

One north star — D90 renewal — moved by four bets shipped in three phases.

18% → 38%

D90 Gold renewal rate

north-star metric

45% →
<30%
3-month churn

the headline problem

4 → 4.4

orders / member / month

habit formation

35% → 60%

multi-vertical usage

ecosystem lock-in



PHASE 1 · Q3

Gold Everywhere + Priority Support

Integration-led wins: membership flag across Blinkit & District; Gold support lane live.



PHASE 2 · Q4

Gold Express pilot

3 metros, lunch daypart only. Scale on >95% on-time; kill if the promise can't hold.



PHASE 3 · Q1+

AI Concierge

Start with a rule-based “usuals” rail; graduate to ML once acceptance clears 35%.

Gold shouldn't be a coupon. It should be the reason the app opens.

Thank you — Team Visionary Vanguard · Abhinav Jain · Aryan Maan · Manit Singh · Mayank Gupta · Soumyadeep Podder